

Fieldwork in our grounds

Pupil resources | BUILD Humanities Summer 1

Carry out simple fieldwork in the grounds.

Practice tally: one object, one mark

Invented data — not observations of our grounds

Feature	Area A	Area B
Benches		
Bins		
Trees		

Return to class. Count the marks. Check the total.

Use the paper tally sheet outdoors. Leave devices indoors. If fieldwork cannot happen, use the labelled practice tally and mark your work PRACTICE.

Paper fieldwork tally

Real observations | Take this page, a pencil and a clipboard

Question: How many benches, bins and trees are in our two agreed areas?

Stay with the supervising adult. Follow the agreed route inside the grounds. Observe from the path. Make one mark for each object. Count each object only once. Return to class to total and check. No device is needed outdoors; do not photograph people.

Date and agreed areas A / B

Area	Feature	Tally marks	Total
A	Benches		
A	Bins		
A	Trees		
B	Benches		
B	Bins		
B	Trees		

Group each set of five marks: four upright lines and a fifth line across them. Leave a clear gap before the next group. If unsure whether an object is in the area, ask the adult before counting.

Practice tally fallback

INVENTED DATA | Classroom use when fieldwork cannot take place

Read the marks in the picture, then write each total below. These are practice observations, not results from our grounds. Area A and Area B do not overlap.

Practice tally: one object, one mark

Invented data — not observations of our grounds

Feature	Area A	Area B
Benches		
Bins		
Trees		

Return to class. Count the marks. Check the total.

Feature	Area A total	Area B total	Both areas
Benches			
Bins			
Trees			

One thing I did to check

Arrival task

Supported | Fieldwork in our grounds

Fieldwork means observing a place. A tally uses one mark for each object. You can learn the method without an earlier lesson.

Use the reference sheet. Start with questions 1 and 2.

1. Show one tally mark.

Help: One mark means one object.

My response

2. How many marks are | |?

Help: Touch each mark once.

My response

3. Choose a feature to count: a bench or someone's name.

Help: Count an object in the grounds.

My response

4. Who leads the route?

Help: Choose the adult or a pupil walking away alone.

My response

Arrival task

Standard | Fieldwork in our grounds

Fieldwork means observing a place. A tally uses one mark for each object. You can learn the method without an earlier lesson.

Use the reference sheet. Start with questions 1 and 2.

1. What does one tally mark stand for?

Help: Think of one thing counted.

My response

2. Record three trees with tally marks.

Help: One mark for each tree.

My response

3. Why label the study area?

Help: Think about using the sheet later.

My response

4. What should you do if a stop is unavailable?

Help: The route is supervised.

My response

Arrival task

Stretch | Fieldwork in our grounds

Fieldwork means observing a place. A tally uses one mark for each object. You can learn the method without an earlier lesson.

Use the reference sheet. Start with questions 1 and 2.

1. How would you tally five trees?

Help: The fifth mark crosses the first four.

My response

2. Why can counting one tree twice mislead us?

Help: Think about the total.

My response

3. How can two areas overlap?

Help: Think about seeing the same feature twice.

My response

4. Can practice data prove we went outdoors?

Help: Think about the source label.

My response

Shared activity

Put the fieldwork method in order

1. Put the fieldwork method cards in order.
2. Rehearse with the practice observation card and paper tally sheet.
3. Swap observer and recorder roles. Check that each object gets one mark.

Number these cards 1–4, or cut them apart and put them in order. Explain how the order helps the count.

Method card	Order
Then: make one tally mark for each object seen.	
First: agree the question, route, boundaries and roles.	
Finally: return to class, total the marks and check.	
Next: look carefully in the agreed study area.	

Our evidence and explanation

Independent task

Supported | Fieldwork in our grounds

Carry out simple fieldwork in the grounds.

Use the paper tally sheet outdoors. Leave devices indoors. If fieldwork cannot happen, use the labelled practice tally and mark your work PRACTICE.

1. Use the agreed paper route with the adult.
2. Count one feature type in area A. Make one mark per object.
3. Point to or say your total and one check when back inside.

Help: Choose benches or bins. Adult reads the row; you make the marks. Use your usual communication support.

Study area and feature

My tally and total

How I checked

Real fieldwork or practice fallback

Further challenge: Try the same method in area B with less prompting.

Independent task

Standard | Fieldwork in our grounds

Carry out simple fieldwork in the grounds.

Use the paper tally sheet outdoors. Leave devices indoors. If fieldwork cannot happen, use the labelled practice tally and mark your work PRACTICE.

1. Observe the agreed feature types in A and B on the supervised route.
2. Keep a separate tally for each feature and area.
3. Return, total each row and explain one check yourself.

Help: Observer points; recorder marks. Swap roles so everyone has their own recording evidence.

Study area and feature

My tally and total

How I checked

Real fieldwork or practice fallback

Further challenge: Combine one feature's totals across the two non-overlapping areas.

Independent task

Stretch | Fieldwork in our grounds

Carry out simple fieldwork in the grounds.

Use the paper tally sheet outdoors. Leave devices indoors. If fieldwork cannot happen, use the labelled practice tally and mark your work PRACTICE.

1. Use the same supervised route and clearly defined boundaries.
2. Record each feature once, then check a row independently.
3. Combine the totals for one feature and explain your method.
4. Name a limitation of today's observations.

Help: Say: We counted ____ in area _____. We avoided repeats by _____.

Study area and feature

My tally and total

How I checked

Real fieldwork or practice fallback

Further challenge: Suggest how to make a repeat observation more consistent.

Exit tickets

Use only your chosen route

Give your own response. Your usual communication support can stay.

Supported

1. Show one tally you made and its total. Point, speak or write.

2. Show or explain one way you kept the count accurate. State whether you used real observations or practice data.

Standard

1. What did you observe and how many did you record? Name the feature and study area.

2. How did you check your tally? State whether the source was real fieldwork or practice.

Stretch

1. Explain one checked result using the labelled tally. Give the feature, area and total.

2. What could affect a repeat count? Suggest one improvement and identify real or practice data.
